

Responding to an RFP

This guide shows you how to tackle a formal Request for Proposal, which is often your shot at bigger federal contracts.

What it is. An RFP response is your detailed proposal to a government agency. It's how you show them you understand their problem and have the best solution. The whole game is reading Sections L and M of the solicitation. L tells you exactly what to write, and M explains how they'll score it.

When to use it. You use this when an agency issues a formal Request for Proposal, usually for contracts over \$250,000. These are typically complex, competitive bids where they aren't just looking for the lowest price, but the best value.

How to use it.

- First, open "How to Read Section L & M" and the "RFP Response Playbook." Read Sections L and M of the RFP carefully.
- Next, use the "Compliance Matrix" and "Proposal Outline & Compliance Shell (Word)" to build your response outline. Make sure you answer every single requirement in order.
- Then, use the "Win Themes Workbook" to develop your core messages. These are the key reasons they should pick you.
- Finally, use the "Color-Team Review Templates" to get fresh eyes on your draft before you submit.

Watch out for. Don't just copy and paste your capabilities statement. Every word in your response needs to directly address a requirement from Section L or M.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/rfp-response> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/rfq> (RFQ Quoting)